

Three of the month's biggest events, all in the back half

The inflation gauge the Federal Reserve actually watches lands Wednesday morning, the largest company in the world reports Wednesday night, and **the new Fed chair gives his first Jackson Hole speech at 10:00 on Friday. Monday and Tuesday carry almost nothing.**

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01 The week

Where the week starts, and the two times that matter. **No forecast figure appears anywhere on this page**, and section 05 says why.

7,674.37 S and P 500, Friday	15.13 VIX, from 14.25	4.74% US 10 year	+5.66% Crude oil, last week	8:30am Core PCE, Wed	10:00am Jackson Hole, Fri
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Where the scheduled risk sits. Times are eastern. The first half of the week is close to empty and the back half carries three of the month's biggest events.

MON 24 Clear Nothing scheduled that moves it CLEAR	TUE 25 10:00 Confidence and new home sales DATA	WED 26 8:30 Core PCE, then Nvidia after the bell TWICE OVER	THU 27 8:30 Claims, and the reaction to Nvidia REACTION	FRI 28 10:00 The new chair speaks for the first time THE DAY
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Red top marks the week's main event. Green marks the one morning with nothing scheduled.

02 Friday, and why a first speech is different

One item on this calendar matters more than the rest of it combined.

- Friday 10:00 am, the** (Jackson Hole symposium (an annual gathering of central bankers in Wyoming, hosted by the Kansas City Fed, where the Fed chair traditionally speaks)) **keynote. This is the new chair's first one**, and a first speech is read for what kind of chair he intends to be, not only for what he says about rates.

- **At the July meeting he inherited, three of twelve officials recorded a** (dissent (a vote against the decision the committee reached)), **and all three of them wanted rates to go up. A first keynote delivered into a divided committee is a different event from a routine one.**

03 Wednesday counts twice

Two unrelated things land on the same day, twelve hours apart.

- **8:30 in the morning brings** (PCE (personal consumption expenditures, the inflation measure the Federal Reserve prefers over the better known consumer price index)), **and it arrives two days before the chair speaks. The order matters: the inflation reading is already known to him when he stands up.**
- **After the closing bell, Nvidia reports,** alongside Salesforce, CrowdStrike and HP. **Nvidia went into its own results down 4.6 percent on the week and finished within a quarter of a dollar of the week's low.**
- **Those results are not felt on Wednesday. They are felt at Thursday's opening,** which is how an evening announcement usually works.

04 Who took the week down

The market fell, and the falling was not spread evenly.

- **Cap weighted** (the S and P 500 you see quoted, where big companies count for more) **fell 1.43 percent;** the **equal weighted** version of the same 500 fell only **0.49 percent. That is twice running, and it is a three to one gap.**
- Two measures of (breadth (how many companies join a move, rather than how far the biggest ones travel)) **set fresh 52 week highs inside a losing week and then gave them back. The small company index made its high on Monday and the equally weighted 500 made its own on Wednesday.**
- Meanwhile **gold rose 6.85 percent** and (WTI (West Texas Intermediate, the American crude oil benchmark)) **added 5.66 percent, a third straight week above five. Both are costs, not growth.**

05 What this page will not claim

Three refusals, each of them deliberate.

- **No forecast figure appears anywhere above.** The calendar source used for the dates **again returned finished results for days that have not happened yet,** which cannot be real. **That is the third week running. Its dates and times were checked against a second source and kept. Its numbers were thrown away.**
- **The page's own summary of itself claimed the opposite,** saying no future day showed a result, **directly contradicting the table above it. The table was believed and the summary was not.**
- **The** (dealer positioning (how options market makers are hedged, which shapes whether moves get damped or amplified)) **read is unavailable for the fourth week running.** One tracker was found and **rejected because it failed its own internal check. Blank beats guessed.**

THE ONE LINE

A calm market walks into an inflation reading, the largest earnings report of the quarter, and a new chair speaking for the first time, and it is paying almost nothing for protection against any of them.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Release dates and times: tradingeconomics.com calendar, live lookup August 23 2026 (page renders UTC, converted at eastern equals UTC minus 4, offset proved against thirteen permanently fixed slots), confirmed against a second independent week ahead calendar; Levels: Yahoo Finance daily bars at the August 21 settle. Chicago PMI date: MNI Chicago Business Barometer publication calendar. Earnings dates: Kiplinger and CNBC week ahead, August 21 2026; Jackson Hole dates and the 10:00 eastern keynote slot: Kansas City Fed symposium listing and MNI, August 27 to 29 2026. Educational, not financial advice. A record of what happened and what is scheduled, for Mann's own discretion.

Glossary

Jackson Hole An annual central banking gathering in Wyoming. The Fed chair traditionally speaks on the Friday.

PCE Personal consumption expenditures. The inflation measure the Federal Reserve prefers.

Dissent An official voting against the decision. Three did so in July, all wanting a rise.

Cap weighted Bigger companies count for more.

Equal weighted Every company counted the same.

Breadth How many companies join a move.

VIX The market expectation of swing over the next 30 days, priced from options. Low means calm is assumed.

Dealer positioning How options market makers are hedged. It shapes whether moves get damped or amplified.